

Adam Hickey

Lead Product Designer • Design Systems & AI Enablement

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Professional Summary

Lead product designer with 20 years of experience helping global organizations like Cargill, Intel, and Toro make dozens of products feel like one, through design systems, governance, accessibility, and AI-assisted workflows. I build the system and then keep it healthy, so product, engineering, and business teams ship consistent work the business can measure. I use AI to scale the design system, not just my own output. The judgment calls stay human.

Experience

RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer (2013 – Present)

- Lead enterprise product design and UX strategy for clients in manufacturing, healthcare, financial services, and the public sector.
- Work with product, engineering, and business teams so design decisions show up in the numbers they already track: efficiency, adoption, quality, and ROI.
- Build and govern design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco, and Sitecore platforms.
- Use AI to scale the design system. Drafting documentation, auditing for drift, checking design against code, and pulling research together, with human judgment on every decision.
- Lead accessibility, DesignOps, and governance practices, and mentor designers on using AI with the design system without dropping the standards.

Selected projects

- Scaling enterprise product design across 40+ SAP applications (design systems, governance, accessibility)
- Reducing operational overhead by 80% through a USDA grant-management portal (research, workflows, public website, online community, accessibility)
- Orchestrating real-time logistics for a 450+ truck fleet (cockpit UI, real-time fleet visibility, dispatcher workflows)

Core Capabilities

Product Strategy • Design Judgment • Systems Thinking • Research & Synthesis • AI-Enhanced Design • Rapid Prototyping • Design Systems • Human-Centered AI • Accessibility • Facilitation • Information Architecture • Interaction & UI Design • Usability Testing • Analytics & UX Measurement

Design Tools & Platforms

Figma/FigJam • Adobe Creative Suite • Claude Code • Gemini • ChatGPT • Sitecore • Umbraco • SAP Fiori • SharePoint • Power Apps • Power BI • Google Analytics • Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA, screen readers, keyboard navigation)

Education

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)

Prior Professional Experience

Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer (Jan 2008 – Apr 2013)

- Created user flows, wireframes, and visual prototypes for digital products.
- Built front-end experiences using HTML, CSS, and jQuery in Joomla! and WordPress.
- Led rebrands and built complete visual identity systems.

LEVEL — Interactive Designer (Jan 2006 – Jan 2008)

- Designed and developed front-end websites in HTML, CSS, and Flash; partnered with project managers, creative leads, writers, and developers.

ByDesign — Graphic Designer (Jan 2005 – Jan 2006)

- Supported University of Minnesota and Twin Cities clients with in-house creative; led a small design team producing interactive Flash games and digital assets.